

UCU 112: Creativity and Innovation – Exam Revision Notes

UNIT 1: Conceptual Foundations

Creativity: The mental capability or process of generating new, unique, alternative, and useful ideas.

Innovation: The successful implementation of creative ideas into tangible, value-producing outcomes.

Creativity vs Innovation: Creativity = thinking phase; Innovation = action phase. Creativity focuses on novelty, while innovation focuses on value and implementation.

UNIT 2: Creative Thinking Techniques & Skills

Evolution, Revolution, Synthesis, Reapplication, and Changing Direction.

Key Skills: Brainstorming, Reframing, and Ego Management.

UNIT 3: Types & Models of Thinking

Divergent vs Convergent Thinking; Lateral vs Linear Thinking; Systems Thinking.

UNIT 4: Five Stages of the Creative Process

Preparation → Incubation → Illumination → Evaluation → Implementation.

UNIT 5: Obstacles, Culture and Ethics

Barriers: Perceptual, Emotional, and Cultural/Environmental blocks.

Nature vs Nurture, Education System Shift, Leadership Style, and Ethics in Creativity.

UNIT 9: Gender Issues in Creativity and Innovation

Creativity and innovation are human attributes shared equally by men and women.

Creative Potential vs Creative Output: Potential is equal across genders; differences in output are largely due to environmental and societal factors.

Factors Affecting Gender Expression of Creativity:

1. Cultural Upbringing and Socialization
2. Access to Quality Education and Resources
3. Institutional and Environmental Barriers
4. Risk-Taking Constraints

Exam Tip: Use the Nature vs Nurture framework when answering gender and creativity questions.

Quick Exam Checklist

Techniques: Evolution, Revolution, Synthesis, Reapplication, Changing Direction.

Stages: Preparation, Incubation, Illumination, Evaluation, Implementation.

Thinking Types: Divergent vs Convergent; Linear vs Lateral.